Dependency Map

Make cross-team dependencies visible: who needs what from whom, by when, and which ones are at risk.

Coordinate Teams · Dependency Board · Red String · Reduce, Don't Just Manage

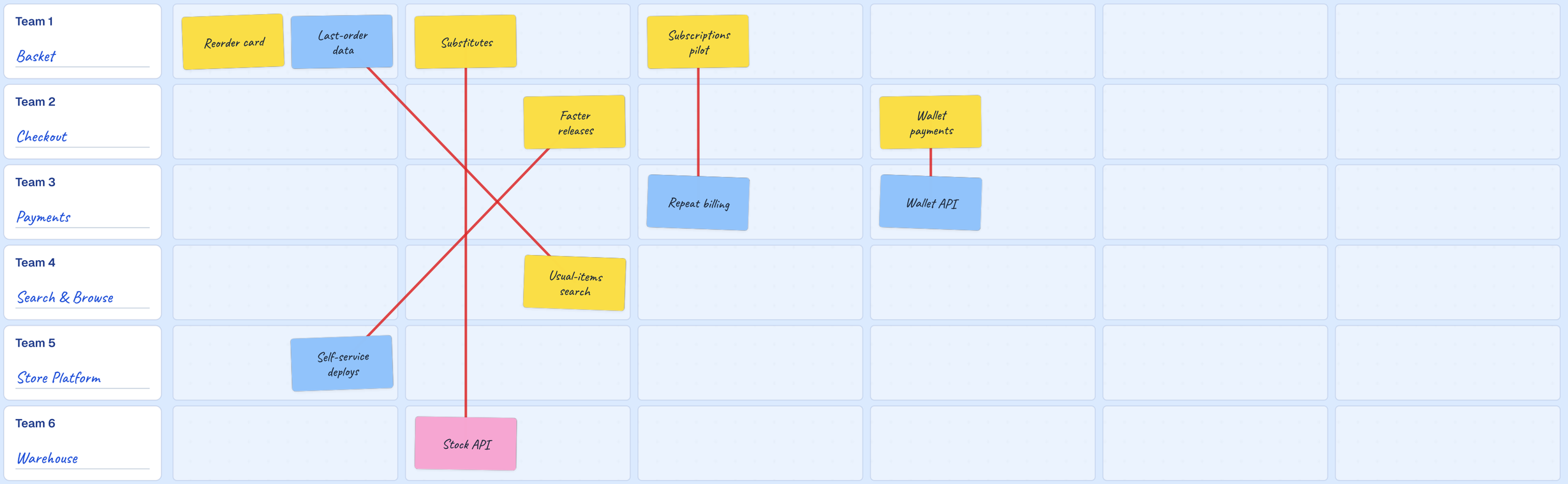
WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEGEND

- Yellow = Work item
- Blue = Dependency
- Pink = At risk
- Red string = link

1 Dependency Board

PLACE THE ITEM WHERE IT'S NEEDED · LINK IT TO WHO PROVIDES IT



2 Dependency Register

ONE ROW PER DEPENDENCY

#	NEEDED BY	PROVIDED BY	WHAT	BY WHEN	STATUS	OWNER
1	Basket	Warehouse	Stock API for substitutes	Iteration 2	at risk	Sam
2	Basket	Payments	Repeat billing for subscriptions	Iteration 3	agreed	Tom
3	Checkout	Store Platform	Self-service deploys	Iteration 1	done	Checkout lead
4	Search & Browse	Basket	Last-order data	Iteration 1	done	Jo
5	Checkout	Payments	Wallet API	Iteration 4	agreed	Payments lead

Status: agreed · at risk · blocked · done

3 Reduce Dependencies

BEST DEPENDENCY = NO DEPENDENCY

- [ ] Could the team do it themselves (skills, access)?
- [ ] Could we re-order the work so it's needed later?
- [x] Could a stub, mock or contract unblock us?
- [x] Does it keep happening? Change team boundaries

Top dependency to remove: Stock API: give Basket read access

Owner: Sam, with the Warehouse lead

"Who are we waiting on, and do they know?"

"Which dependency could we remove instead of managing?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/better-delivery-toolkit